

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 4 2

♥ 5

♦ J 5 3

♣ A K 9 7 4

♠ K Q J 10 7 5

♥ A J 8 6 3

♦ A

♣ 5



♠ 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K Q 10 9 6 2

♣ 10 8 6 2

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 9 7 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ Q J 3

Since there has not been a clear agreement on the trump suit you can assume it is ♥s, the last bid suit.

So you have two Key-Cards (♠A and ♥K, along with the ♥Q). You therefore bid 5♠ and partner bids 6♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♠

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♣K

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ 10 7 4
 ♦ A K J 9
 ♣ 9 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A Q J 3

♦ Q 6

♣ K Q J



♠ 6 4

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10 7 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7 3 2

♥ K 9 5

♦ 8 5

♣ A 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	5 ♣
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	5 ♠
All Pass			
5 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ K			

Partner's jump to 4 ♠ indicates he is prepared to play at game even if you have as few as 6 points. So he must have 20 points or so. With your 14 that puts you in slam range.

Despite your conviction that this hand is going to slam you should **NOT** ask for Key-Cards holding a worthless doubleton. Instead, you make a slam try by bidding your cheapest control, 5 ♣. Partner says 5 ♥. What is your next bid?

You can only say 5 ♠. Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he held the Ace since controls are bid up-the-line. His failure to show it means he doesn't have it. Since you might be off the first two ♦ tricks you stop at 5 ♠.

Yes, partner should probably have opened 2NT. Sometimes partners don't make the bids you think they oughta.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 10 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 4
♣ J 9 6 5

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ A 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A 8 2



♠ A 4

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 9 6 2

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ 5

♣ K Q 3

You have 3 Key-Cards so you bid 5♦. Partner bids
6♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥2

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 6
 ♥ 7 4 3
 ♦ 10 9 8 7 4
 ♣ 7 5 4

♠ K Q 8 4

♥ A J 6

♦ J 3

♣ Q J 8 3



♠ 5 3

♥ 10 9 8 2

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ 10 9 2

♠ A J 9 7 2

♥ K Q 5

♦ K 5

♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♣4

Your partnership plays Jacoby 2NT convention, so partner's 2NT shows a game-forcing raise in ♠s. Your 3NT bid indicates a 5-card suit and "extra values". Partner's 4♥ is a control-bid showing the ♥A.

What you need to know now about partner's hand is Key-Cards so you bid 4NT. He answers 5♠. What is your bid?

Partner's response says 2 Key-Cards and the ♠Q. So you are missing either the trump King or the ♦A. So you shouldn't bid 7, but you will almost surely make 6. You bid 6♠.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ K J 8 5 3 2
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7



♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♦
All Pass			
6♦ by South			
Lead: ♣8			

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2



♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ —

♣ A K Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♠7			

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.